PRIMARY ECONOMIC ACTIVITIES: AGRICULTURE

AGRICULTURAL GEOGRAPHY AS A → FARMING-SYSTEM CLASSIFICATION BY ECOLOGY → VON THUNEN RINGS AND → WORLD CROP REGIONS AND → INDIA'S AGRO-CLIMATIC MOSAIC, GREEN → FISHING, FORESTRY, MINING AND

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

● PRIMARY CORE FLOW ● SUBORDINATE EXTRA ● APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g14 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00

AGRICULTURAL GEOGRAPHY AS A NATURAL-HUMAN-MARKET SYSTEM

AGRICULTURAL GEOGRAPHY AS A NATURAL-HUMAN-MARKET SYSTEM · AGRICULTURAL GEOGRAPHY · WHERE DOES PRODUCTION OCCUR, WHY THERE, HOW ORGANISED, AND · NATURAL BASE HUMAN SYSTEM MARKET SYSTEM CLIMATE LABOUR/HOLDING DEMAND · FARMING SYSTEM LOCATION · VALUE CHAIN SPATIAL GAINS AND COSTS FED BACK TO · SIX CONTROLS · CLIMATE, RELIEF, SOIL, WATER, LABOUR, MARKET//TRANSPORT

AGRICULTURAL GEOGRAPHY → Where does production occur, why there, how organised, and how does the pattern change through → NATURAL BASE HUMAN SYSTEM MARKET SYSTEM climate labour/holding demand relief technology → transport soil tenure/capital storage/processing water institutions price and trade links → FARMING SYSTEM location → seasonality → intensity → surplus → value chain spatial gains and

CORE CLAIM

- AGRICULTURAL GEOGRAPHY
- NATURAL BASE HUMAN SYSTEM MARKET SYSTEM climate labour/holding demand relief technology

MECHANISM

- transport soil tenure/capital storage/processing water institutions price and trade links
- FARMING SYSTEM location → seasonality → intensity → surplus → value chain spatial gains and costs feed back to soil, water, labour and region
- Six controls: climate, relief, soil, water, labour, market/transport.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- MUST REMEMBER: Agricultural geography reconstructs land use through physical controls, tenure, labour, technology, markets and policy
- It compares subsistence/commercial, intensive/extensive, plantation, mixed, dairy, Mediterranean, shifting, pastoral and von
- Thünen location logics before mapping India's crop seasons and agro-regions.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Thünen location logics before mapping India's crop seasons and agro-regions.

01

STAGE 01

FARMING-SYSTEM CLASSIFICATION BY ECOLOGY, LABOUR AND MARKET

FARMING-SYSTEM CLASSIFICATION BY ECOLOGY, LABOUR AND MARKET · TYPICAL SETTING · SHIFTING CULTIVATION · CLEARING + FALLOW · HUMID FOREST MARGINS · WET-RICE INTENSIVE · SMALL, LABOUR, WATER · MONSOON VALLEYS

SYSTEM	ORGANISATION	TYPICAL SETTING
Shifting cultivation	clearing + fallow	humid forest margins
Wet-rice intensive	small, labour, water	monsoon valleys
Nomadic pastoralism	mobile herds	arid sparse pasture
Mixed farming	crop-livestock link	temperate regions
Mediterranean	winter rain system	west-coast margins

CORE CLAIM

- TYPICAL SETTING
- Shifting cultivation
- clearing + fallow
- humid forest margins
- Wet-rice intensive

MECHANISM

- Mixed farming
- crop-livestock link
- temperate regions
- winter rain system
- west-coast margins

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- Dairy/market garden
- perishable + urban
- city hinterlands
- CLASSIFICATION AXES subsistence/commercial
- crop/livestock mix sedentary/mobile

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: High output per hectare is not the same as commercial orientation.

02

STAGE 02

VON THUNEN RINGS AND THE SURVIVAL OF DISTANCE

VON THUNEN RINGS AND THE SURVIVAL OF DISTANCE · CENTRAL MARKET DAIRY · HIGH DECAY, FREQUENT TRIPS FORESTRY · HEAVY TRANSPORT BURDEN FIELD CROPS · LOWER PERISHABILITY LIVESTOCK · EXTENSIVE OUTER USE DISTANCE UP · FREIGHT/RELIABILITY COST UP · BID RENT GENERALLY DOWN PERISHABILITY + DELIVERY FREQUENCY +

CENTRAL MARKET dairy / vegetables

High decay, frequent trips forestry / fuelwood → heavy transport burden field crops → lower perishability livestock / ranching

CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL MARKET dairy / vegetables
- high decay, frequent trips forestry / fuelwood
- heavy transport burden field crops

MECHANISM

- lower perishability livestock / ranching
- extensive outer use distance up → freight/reliability cost up → bid rent
- generally down perishability + delivery frequency + land rent decide near-market use

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- MODERN MODIFIERS cold chain + expressway + processing + digital markets + policy stretch; distort or split rings; they do not abolish cost and access
- Answer route: assumptions → mechanism → modification → surviving use
- limits from relief, multiple markets and institutions.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Answer route: assumptions → mechanism → modification → surviving use.

03

STAGE 03

WORLD CROP REGIONS AND ECOLOGICAL REQUIREMENTS

WORLD CROP REGIONS AND ECOLOGICAL REQUIREMENTS · ECOLOGICAL BUNDLE · BROAD GEOGRAPHY · WARMTH + MANAGED WATER · MONSOON VALLEYS/DELTAS · COOL GROWTH, DRY RIPENING · TEMPERATE AND WINTER BELTS · FROST-FREE WARMTH

CROP	ECOLOGICAL BUNDLE	BROAD GEOGRAPHY
Rice	warmth + managed water	monsoon valleys/deltas
Wheat	cool growth, dry ripening	temperate and winter belts
Cotton	frost-free warmth	subtropical plains/plateaus
Jute	humid alluvium + retting	eastern deltas/ belt
Tea	humid acidic slopes	Asian tropical highlands

CORE CLAIM

- ECOLOGICAL BUNDLE
- BROAD GEOGRAPHY
- warmth + managed water
- monsoon valleys/deltas
- cool growth, dry ripening

MECHANISM

- humid alluvium + retting
- eastern deltas/ belt
- humid acidic slopes
- Asian tropical highlands
- shaded drained uplands

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- REGIONAL LOGIC
- Monsoon Asia → intensive rice
- temperate plains → commercial grain
- Mediterranean margins → winter crops, vines, olives and fruits
- Tropical estates → plantation crops

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: A crop-soil link is an association, not an exclusive rule.

04

STAGE 04

INDIA'S AGRO-CLIMATIC MOSAIC, GREEN REVOLUTION AND FOOD CHAIN

INDIA'S AGRO-CLIMATIC MOSAIC, GREEN REVOLUTION AND FOOD CHAIN · INDIA'S AGRICULTURAL MOSAIC · IRRIGATED WHEAT-RICE AND PROCUREMENT CORE · EASTERN DELTAS · RICE, JUTE AND WATER-RICH FARMING · DRYLAND DECCAN · MILLETS, PULSES, OILSEEDS AND VARIABLE RAINFALL · WESTERN PLATEAU

INDIA'S AGRICULTURAL MOSAIC → North-west : irrigated wheat-rice and procurement core → Eastern deltas : rice, jute and water-rich farming → Dryland Deccan : millets, pulses, oilseeds and variable rainfall → Western plateau : cotton and mixed irrigated-dryland systems

CORE CLAIM

- INDIA'S AGRICULTURAL MOSAIC
- North-west : irrigated wheat-rice and procurement core
- Eastern deltas : rice, jute and water-rich farming
- Dryland Deccan : millets, pulses, oilseeds and variable rainfall

MECHANISM

- Western plateau : cotton and mixed irrigated-dryland systems
- Highlands : tea, coffee, spices and horticulture
- Mountains : horticulture, pastoral and terrace systems
- GREEN REVOLUTION PACKAGE

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- HYV + assured irrigation + fertiliser + credit + extension + procurement early concentration: Punjab +
- Haryana + western Uttar Pradesh higher grain output → procurement → central pool → NFSA/PDS movement
- SECOND-GENERATION FEEDBACK water-table decline + nutrient imbalance + residue pressure rice-wheat lock-in → regional divergence
- Productive success and ecological stress can coexist in the same region.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Productive success and ecological stress can coexist in the same region.

05

STAGE 05

FISHING, FORESTRY, MINING AND QUARRYING THROUGH PHYSIOGRAPHY

FISHING, FORESTRY, MINING AND QUARRYING THROUGH PHYSIOGRAPHY · PHYSICAL BASE · HUMAN FILTER · SHELF, NUTRIENTS, MIXING · HARBOUR, COLD CHAIN · INLAND FISH · RIVER, TANK, RESERVOIR · RIGHTS, SEED, MARKETS

ACTIVITY	PHYSICAL BASE	HUMAN FILTER
Fishing	shelf, nutrients, mixing	harbour, cold chain
Inland fish	river, tank, reservoir	rights, seed, markets
Forestry	climate, altitude, species	access, tenure, rules
Mining	ore body or fuel basin	grade, power, transport
Quarrying	accessible bulk material	demand, regulation

CORE CLAIM

- PHYSICAL BASE
- HUMAN FILTER
- shelf, nutrients, mixing
- harbour, cold chain
- Inland fish

MECHANISM

- climate, altitude, species
- access, tenure, rules
- ore body or fuel basin
- grade, power, transport
- accessible bulk material

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- technology + transport + institutions + rights determine realised activity
- Indian cues
- central/NE forests → timber and NTFP
- shields → many metallic ores sedimentary basins → coal/limestone
- margins → offshore hydrocarbons

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: central/NE forests → timber and NTFP | shields → many metallic ores sedimentary basins → coal/limestone | margins → offshore hydrocarbons.

06

STAGE 06

SUSTAINABLE AGRICULTURE AND INTERVENTION STACK

SUSTAINABLE AGRICULTURE AND INTERVENTION STACK · REGIONAL PRODUCTION PRESSURE MONSOON VARIABILITY + FRAGMENTED HOLDINGS + · RESPONSE STACK SOIL AND WATER CONSERVATION · CROP-WATER ALIGNMENT AND DIVERSIFICATION · EFFICIENT IRRIGATION AND RESILIENT SEED SYSTEMS · STORAGE, AGGREGATION, PROCESSING AND COLD CHAIN · CREDIT, INSURANCE, EXTENSION AND MARKET ACCESS · PROCUREMENT REFORM WITH FOOD-SECURITY SAFEGUARDS

REGIONAL PRODUCTION PRESSURE monsoon variability + fragmented holdings + unequal irrigation soil decline + water

RESPONSE STACK soil and water conservation → crop-water alignment and diversification → efficient irrigation and resilient seed systems

CORE CLAIM

- REGIONAL PRODUCTION PRESSURE monsoon variability + fragmented holdings + unequal irrigation soil decline + water stress + market risk
- RESPONSE STACK soil and water conservation
- crop-water alignment and diversification
- efficient irrigation and resilient seed systems
- storage, aggregation, processing and cold chain

MECHANISM

- credit, insurance, extension and market access
- procurement reform with food-security safeguards
- local monitoring of income, nutrition and ecology
- EVIDENCE FIREWALL estimate is not final
- output is not procurement

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- procurement is not stock stock is not consumption
- MSP announcement is not actual purchase
- SCHEME STATUS announcement → approval → guidelines → selection → funds
- physical output → service outcome → long-term impact
- Technology raises output only where water, knowledge and institutions converge.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EVIDENCE FIREWALL estimate is not final | output is not procurement | procurement is not stock stock is not consumption | MSP announcement is not actual purchase.

07

STAGE 07

MAP-ANSWER AND MAINS SPINE FOR AGRICULTURAL GEOGRAPHY

MAP-ANSWER AND MAINS SPINE FOR AGRICULTURAL GEOGRAPHY · WHY IS AGRICULTURAL CHANGE SPATIALLY UNEQUAL? · 1. DEFINE · LOCATION, SEASONALITY, ORGANISATION AND CHANGE · 2. MAP · IRRIGATED NW · EASTERN DELTAS · DRY DECCAN

QUESTION: Why is agricultural change spatially unequal?

1. DEFINE: location, seasonality, organisation and change → 2. MAP: irrigated NW → eastern deltas

CORE CLAIM

- QUESTION: Why is agricultural change spatially unequal?
- 1. DEFINE: location, seasonality, organisation and change
- 2. MAP: irrigated NW
- eastern deltas
- dry Deccan

MECHANISM

- plantation hills
- 3. BUILD CONTROL MATRIX climate + relief + soil + water + labour + market/transport
- 4. EXPLAIN SYSTEM subsistence → surplus → specialisation → processing → value chain
- 5. ADD NAMED EVIDENCE
- Green Revolution core, procurement geography or physiographic activity

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- 6. EVALUATE productivity + food security versus water, soil and regional inequality
- 7. QUALIFY AND CONCLUDE diversify only with purchase assurance, processing and transition support
- Claim → evidence → spatial mechanism → distributional/ecological limit
- region-sensitive verdict.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Claim → evidence → spatial mechanism → distributional/ecological limit.

08

STAGE 08

EVIDENCE LADDER AND CONFIDENCE CONTROL

EVIDENCE LADDER AND CONFIDENCE CONTROL · EVIDENCE LADDER · GROUNDED SOURCE · EXAM HEURISTIC · VERIFIED DATED · 2. SOURCE/DATE · PIB, 28 MAY 2025 -CABINET APPROVAL OF MSP FOR · 3. CENTRAL INDIAN AND NORTH-EASTERN FOREST BELTS AND IS

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
EVIDENCE LADDER	2. Source/date: PIB, 28 May 2025 -Cabinet approval of MSP for Kharif...	VERDICT: Source type controls the strength and limits of the historical claim.
1. + grounded source + synthesis / exam heuristic + verified dated...	3. central Indian and north-eastern forest belts and is a principal...	EVIDENCE LADDER

CORE CLAIM

- EVIDENCE LADDER
- 1. + grounded source + synthesis / exam heuristic + verified dated...

MECHANISM

- 2. Source/date: PIB, 28 May 2025 -Cabinet approval of MSP for Kharif...
- 3. central Indian and north-eastern forest belts and is a principal...

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- VERDICT: Source type controls the strength and limits of the historical claim.
- EVIDENCE LADDER

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: Source type controls the strength and limits of the historical claim.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Source type controls the strength and limits of the historical claim.

09

STAGE 09

EXAMINER TRAPS AND CONTESTED BOUNDARIES

EXAMINER TRAPS AND CONTESTED BOUNDARIES · CLOSE DISTINCTIONS · 1. DO NOT TURN A DATED OFFICIAL ESTIMATE INTO · 2. DO NOT TREAT A SCHEME DASHBOARD AS AN · 3. DO NOT BEGIN WITH INDIA-SPECIFIC COMPLEXITY BEFORE THE · QUALIFICATION EARNS MARKS; FALSE CERTAINTY IS A HARD FAILURE. · CLOSE DISTINCTION · KHARIF, RABI AND ZAID ARE SEASONS RATHER THAN CROP

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
CLOSE DISTINCTIONS	3. Do not begin with India-specific complexity before the core location...	net sown area differs from gross cropped area, cropping intensity from yield, MSP announcement from procurement, food security
1. Do not turn a dated official estimate into a timeless fact.	VERDICT: Qualification earns marks; false certainty is a hard failure.	
2. Do not treat a scheme dashboard as an impact evaluation.	CLOSE DISTINCTION: Kharif, rabi and zaid are seasons rather than crop essences	

CORE CLAIM

- CLOSE DISTINCTIONS
- 1. Do not turn a dated official estimate into a timeless fact.
- 2. Do not treat a scheme dashboard as an impact evaluation.

MECHANISM

- 3. Do not begin with India-specific complexity before the core location...
- VERDICT: Qualification earns marks; false certainty is a hard failure.
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Kharif, rabi and zaid are seasons rather than crop essences

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- net sown area differs from gross cropped area, cropping intensity from yield, MSP announcement from procurement, food security

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: Qualification earns marks; false certainty is a hard failure.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Qualification earns marks; false certainty is a hard failure.

10

STAGE 10

INTEGRATED ANSWER SPINE AND QUALIFIED CONCLUSION

INTEGRATED ANSWER SPINE AND QUALIFIED CONCLUSION · ANSWER SPINE · 1. PRACTICE CONTRACT EVERY SOLVED ITEM HAS DEMAND DECODING · 2. NATURAL BASE · FARMING SYSTEM · MARKET LINK · 3. IN PRELIMS, UPSC SEPARATES CLOSE CLASSIFICATIONS. IN MAINS · CLAIM, NAMED EVIDENCE, ANALYSIS AND QUALIFICATION LEAD TO A

ANSWER SPINE

1. Practice contract Every solved item has demand decoding, a detailed → 2. NATURAL BASE → FARMING SYSTEM → LOCATION → MARKET LINK → CHANGE → 3. In Prelims, UPSC separates close classifications. In Mains, it

CORE CLAIM

- ANSWER SPINE
- 1. Practice contract Every solved item has demand decoding, a detailed...
- 2. NATURAL BASE → FARMING SYSTEM → LOCATION → MARKET LINK → CHANGE...

MECHANISM

- 3. In Prelims, UPSC separates close classifications. In Mains, it...
- VERDICT: Claim, named evidence, analysis and qualification lead to a graded...
- EVIDENCE LIMIT: Punjab–Haryana wheat-rice, western Maharashtra sugarcane, Malwa cotton/soybean, Assam tea, Kerala rubber/spices, Karnataka coffee, eastern rice, dryland

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- Deccan millets/pulses and horticultural belts must be explained through water, soil,
- labour, market and policy interactions, with Agriculture Census/land-use/production data source-dated.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: Claim, named evidence, analysis and qualification lead to a graded...

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Claim, named evidence, analysis and qualification lead to a graded.

11

STAGE 11

EVIDENCE LADDER AND CONFIDENCE CONTROL — DEEP-REVIEW SYNTHESIS 2

EVIDENCE LADDER AND CONFIDENCE CONTROL — DEEP-REVIEW SYNTHESIS 2 · EVIDENCE LADDER · GROUNDED SOURCE · EXAM HEURISTIC · VERIFIED DATED · 2. SOURCE/DATE · PIB, 28 MAY 2025 -CABINET APPROVAL OF MSP FOR · 3. CENTRAL INDIAN AND NORTH-EASTERN FOREST BELTS AND IS

EVIDENCE LADDER → 1. + grounded source + synthesis / exam heuristic + verified dated → 2. Source/date: PIB, 28 May 2025 -Cabinet approval of MSP for Kharif... → 3. central Indian and north-eastern forest belts and is a principal → VERDICT: Source type controls the strength and limits of the historical claim.

CORE CLAIM

- EVIDENCE LADDER
- 1. + grounded source + synthesis / exam heuristic + verified dated...

MECHANISM

- 2. Source/date: PIB, 28 May 2025 -Cabinet approval of MSP for Kharif...
- 3. central Indian and north-eastern forest belts and is a principal...

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- VERDICT: Source type controls the strength and limits of the historical claim.
- EVIDENCE LADDER

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: Source type controls the strength and limits of the historical claim.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 1. + grounded source + synthesis / exam heuristic + verified dated.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · 1. INDIA IS AN AGRO-CLIMATIC MOSAIC, NOT ONE FARM · 2. HOLDINGS, IRRIGATION INEQUALITY AND THE SOIL-CROP MAP · 3. GREEN REVOLUTION GEOGRAPHY · 4. PROCUREMENT, THE CENTRAL POOL AND FOOD-SECURITY GEOGRAPHY · 5. REGIONAL IMBALANCE, ECOLOGICAL FEEDBACK AND DIVERSIFICATION · 6. DATED CURRENT-POLICY EVIDENCE AND STATUS DISCIPLINE · 7. ADVANCED EXAM ROUTES

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

- 1. India is an agro-climatic mosaic, not one farm region
- 2. Holdings, irrigation inequality and the soil-crop map
- 3. Green Revolution geography
- 4. Procurement, the central pool and food-security geography

ADVANCED DEBATE

- 5. Regional imbalance, ecological feedback and diversification
- 6. Dated current-policy evidence and status discipline
- 7. Advanced exam routes
- Kharif and Rabi are not mere calendar labels.

LEGACY / NUANCE

- India does not have one uniform rainfed or irrigated agriculture.
- Current rankings must not be inferred from textbook crop belts.
- Owned land is not the same as operated land.
- Average holding size is not a measure of landlessness.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.